

BASEBALL CHATTER

Meeting May
Realign Loops

By MAX GREENWALD

When baseball's bigwigs gather in St. Louis next month for the All-Star game, they will have plenty on their minds.

Because Commissioner Ford Frick is using the occasion to hold a meeting which could realign baseball's leagues from the majors to Class D, Indianapolis will have a definite stake in the proceedings.

This is taking in a lot of ground but Frick evidently has decided to work around George Trautman, the minor league boss.

To begin, evidently all moves hinge on what Brooklyn and the Giants do. Everything points to San Francisco and Los Angeles having big league ball in 1958 with new parks to arise in '59.

Removal of these two rich areas dooms the Pacific Coast loop as a top-ranking circuit. Denver, the bellcow of the American Association, is desired as a colleague by western cities but Bob Howsam, owner of the Bears, doesn't think highly of a league deprived of Los Angeles and San Francisco.

So, it is quite likely a rip will be made in the association with Denver, Omaha, Minneapolis and St. Paul joining Houston, Dallas and two of the coast towns. Seattle has in its favor the fact that it is an airline terminus linked with the Twin Cities but this year has put up the "help" sign financially.

Such a setup would cut Indianapolis loose from a transportation problem which has proven too costly for teams struggling to break even.

The Indians may land in a new orbit looking eastward to some International League cities or they may go south through Louisville in what is now Southern Association territory. Atlanta especially is anxious for AAA recognition which is o.k. with Milwaukee. The Braves supplied Atlanta this year and wouldn't give it the AAA affiliation it lavished on Wichita.

With a second-straight \$100,000-plus loss likely at Wichita, Milwaukee is looking for a way out.

Another topic Frick will want to deal with is pay-as-you-see television, which has such tremendous possibilities that it could be the salvation of the sport. At 50 cents a set, a game at Yankee Stadium would have no trouble making a minimum of \$100,000 a day from closed-circuit telecasts.

And, with this in mind, will the National League permit the Yankees to have exclusive rights to the New York area?

IF DON McMAHON, called up from Wichita by Milwaukee last week, does the job as relief pitcher, Manager Andy Cohen of Indianapolis can be credited with an assist.

While Denver pilot in 1951, Cohen gave McMahon his first test as relief hurler. And the trial wasn't an immediate success.

But McMahon earned his big league chance by helping Wichita into its high-ranking spot by winning six games and saving eight others. His earned-run average was 2.52 for 82 innings.

SAM CRAWFORD, who reached baseball's Hall of Fame because of his slugging, favors giving the game back to the pitchers. He even urges return of the outlawed spitball.

"There's no more danger from a spitball than a fast ball," said Crawford. "Wahoo Sam" was a Detroit teammate of Indianapolis' Ownie Bush.

"I think they've got the pitcher handcuffed," continued the former outfielder. "There are too many restrictions placed on him. Give a pitcher more leeway and you might separate the men from the boys."

"One pitcher around St. Louis used a bar of soap," Crawford recalled. "Believe me, he had a real spitter. He'd try to talk and bubbles would fly all over the place."

HIT-and-RUN—Rudy Regalado, formerly of Indianapolis, was picked for an outfield berth on the Pacific Coast League southern division all-star team. He is with San Diego . . . Baltimore rewarded Pitcher Billy Loes with a \$1,000 pay boost and added \$500 in a new contract for Second Baseman Billy Gardner.

Joseph A. Kuhel, Jr., has been signed into the White Sox system as a pitcher. His father was a first baseman for the Sox and Washington, later managing the Senators and Kansas City . . . When the Dodgers wanted Stan Williams from St. Paul, Manager Max Macon of the Apostles recommended they take Dan McDewitt instead. And the southpaw has turned out to be a sensation in his appearances thus far.

Wichita fans aren't supporting their Braves but seem to have switched their big league affections. They now are bound for St. Louis instead of Kansas City, their former mecca.

Osborne Draws
Coach's Praise

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laughed. But he's batting 1.000 so far.

KENTUCKY players took their time leaving the dressing room. John Turner had his own special souvenir of the game here, under the left eye put there by Ronnie Horn's elbow.

There were no tears in the Indiana dressing room. The Hoosiers gave it all they had and it simply wasn't enough. Indiana Coach Angus Nicoson thought conditioning played a big role for the visitors.

Nick said he heard Carpenter has played in nine all-star games and most of the other Kentucky boys had been in three or four.

Bobby Orrill, the Madison whirlwind who was named Indiana's most valuable player last week in the Louisville game, seemed to be okay.

Indiana called time twice in the last four minutes so Trainer Jim Morris could work on Orrill's charley horse.

But Orrill stayed in the game.

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